

Equity and Inclusion

Summary

The overall picture for equity and inclusion is broadly positive, though with important caveats. A substantial majority of FGD groups reported that the benefits of CFM are being shared equitably and that women benefit from CFM without disproportionately suffering opportunity costs. Notably, a majority of community female FGD groups themselves agreed that women have benefited from CFM. Carbon benefit-sharing agreements between carbon companies and communities are dominated by revenue sharing, while employment and livelihood support components are less commonly included. Responsibility for carbon income sharing decisions within communities was roughly equally split between instances where the CFMG executive makes the decisions and those where the whole CFMG is involved. Importantly, community female and youth FGD groups were significantly more likely than executive and male FGD groups to report inequitable benefit sharing, inadequate participation of women in decision making, and a lack of transparency in benefit sharing. In some CFMGs, community youth groups also identified issues with elite capture and marginalisation of youth. This common divergence in perspective between community members and CFMG executives is a concerning pattern suggesting that a minority of CFMGs have real equity problems that are either not visible from the executive's perspective or deliberately ignored. Poor transparency in benefit sharing and the non-existence of grievance and redress mechanisms were also noted for many CFMGs. Without functioning formal channels through which equity concerns can be raised and addressed, inequitable outcomes risk going undetected and uncorrected. Strengthening these governance mechanisms is essential if CFM is to deliver equitable outcomes for all community members, including women, youth and other vulnerable groups.

Key conclusions

The equity and inclusion outcomes of CFM in Zambia are broadly positive, with meaningful gains in women's formal participation in forest governance. However, the divergence between the perspectives of female and youth groups on one side and CFMG executives on the other is the most important finding of this chapter. It signals that equity problems exist in a subset of CFMGs, and that strengthening transparency, grievance & redress mechanisms and community-wide engagement — particularly with youth — is essential

to ensuring CFM delivers equitable benefits to all.

Introduction

In this chapter, we consider the equitable sharing of benefits arising from community forest management (CFM) and what the impacts of CFM are on vulnerable groups.

We hypothesised that CFM benefits would be unevenly distributed, with women, youth, and vulnerable households receiving less benefit than CFMG executives and older men. We predicted that elite capture and transparency gaps would be more visible to community members than to CFMG leaders, and that CFMGs with better governance would report more equitable benefit-sharing. We also expected that transparent mechanisms for grievance and redress would be rare, making it difficult for disadvantaged groups to challenge inequitable outcomes.

Benefit sharing

We asked FGD groups whether the benefits of CFM were equitably distributed (Figure 1). On the one hand, a substantial majority of responses across the FGD groups asserted that benefits were being shared equitably. However, the proportion of community female and community youth groups that felt that benefits were not being shared equitably was significantly higher than for the CFMG executive and community male FGD groups. Moreover, even among the CFMG executive and community male groups, there were some that agreed that benefits were not being shared equitably.

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Individual interviewees were also asked whether the benefits of CFM were equitably shared. Table 3 shows the percentage reporting this broken down by interviewee role. Again a substantial majority of respondents (83% - 92%) thought that benefits were being shared equitably, and the differences among respondents were not significant. However, there was still minority of respondents that did not think benefits were being equitably shared.

Carbon income benefit sharing

Company-community arrangements

CFMG executive FGDs reported on the components that were included in their carbon finance benefit-sharing arrangement with the carbon developer (Figure 2). Clearly the agreements are dominated by revenue sharing, with relatively few also containing agreements on employment, infrastructure development and livelihood support.

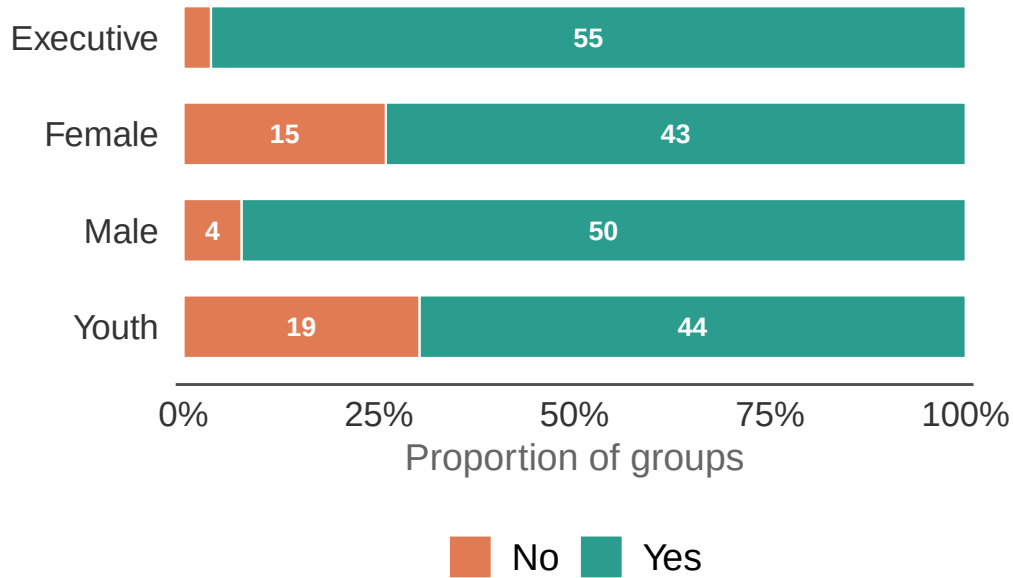


Figure 1: Are the benefits of CFM are equitably shared? The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

Table 1: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on whether communities report equitable benefit sharing.

Model results for equitable benefit sharing — FGD type and governance index

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Executive FGD. Province variance = 0; CFA-within-province variance = 2.144. Marginal $R^2 = 0.412$; conditional $R^2 = \text{NA}$. $n = 217$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Executive FGD)	2.933	1.100	0.0077
Female FGD	-2.794	0.956	0.0035
Male FGD	-0.203	1.239	0.8701
Youth FGD	-2.870	0.943	0.0023
Governance index	0.259	0.147	0.0772

Table 2: Pairwise comparisons among FGD types for equitable benefit sharing.

Pairwise comparisons — FGD type

Estimates are log-odds differences on the emmeans scale. Tukey-adjusted p-values.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive - Female	2.794	0.956	2.923	0.0182
Executive - Male	0.203	1.239	0.163	0.9984
Executive - Youth	2.870	0.943	3.043	0.0125
Female - Male	-2.591	0.949	-2.731	0.0320
Female - Youth	0.077	0.493	0.156	0.9987
Male - Youth	2.668	0.945	2.823	0.0246

Table 3: Percentage of individual interviewees reporting that the benefits of CFM are equitably shared by interviewee role.

Equitable sharing of benefits, as reported by individual interviewees

Values represent the % of positive responses. n = the total number of interview responses. A positive response indicates that benefits of CFM are equitably shared.

Role	n	Agree benefits are equitably shared
Community member	31	92%
CFMG executive member	63	86%
Traditional leader	75	83%
District Forestry Officer	56	90%
Private enterprise rep	32	96%

Table 4: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on whether individuals report equitable benefit sharing.

Model results for equitable benefit sharing — individual interviewees

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Community member. Province variance = 0.619; CFA-within-province variance = 0.325. Marginal $R^2 = 0.096$; conditional $R^2 = 0.298$. $n = 220$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Community member)	3.449	1.489	0.0205
CFMG executive member	-0.753	0.919	0.4128
Traditional leader	-0.938	0.931	0.3135
District Forestry Officer	-0.205	0.954	0.8295
Private enterprise rep	0.903	1.321	0.4940
Male	-0.266	0.650	0.6831
Age	-0.011	0.021	0.6099

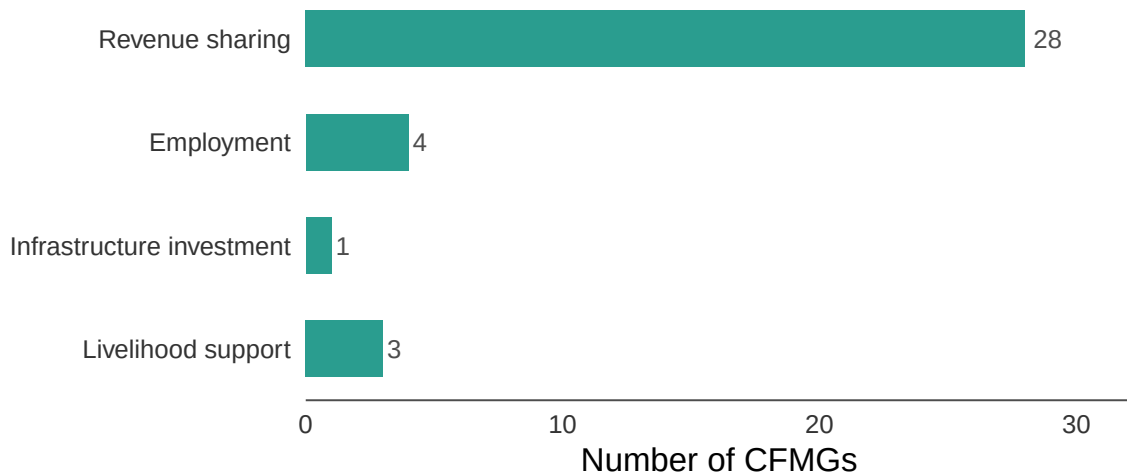


Figure 2: Components included in the carbon finance benefit-sharing arrangement between the carbon company and the community as reported by CFMG executive FGDs. $n = 28$ CFMGs with a carbon finance arrangement responded. Multiple components could be selected.

Within-community sharing

We also asked CFMG executive FGDs about the carbon income sharing arrangements within the community. We first asked who is responsible for the decision-making (Figure 3) and then we asked on what principles the benefit sharing was based (Figure 4). In 12 CFAs, the benefit sharing arrangements are defined in the constitution. Of the remainder, the CFMG executive is responsible for the decision in six, while in seven the entire CFMG is responsible.

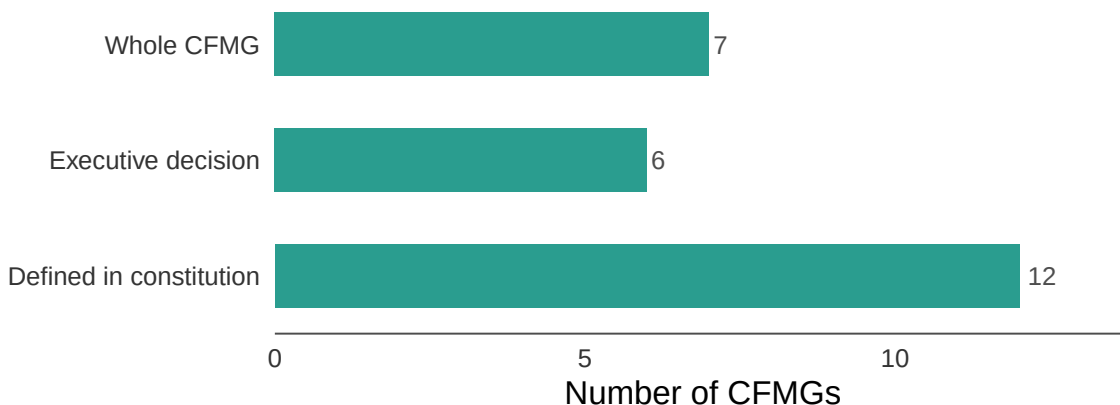


Figure 3: Who decides how carbon income is shared within the community, as reported by CFMG executive FGDs. $n = 28$ CFMGs responded. Multiple options could be selected.

According to the responses of the CFMG executives, seven CFAs shared benefits according to community members' contribution to CFM while six shared them equally among the community households. Meanwhile, only two said that consideration of marginalised or vulnerable groups was a factor in benefit sharing. For 12 of the CFAs, the benefit sharing arrangements are determined in the constitution.

External determination of benefit sharing

We also asked CFMG executive FGDs whether stakeholders outside the community were involved in determining the benefit-sharing arrangement (Figure 5). Again, in 12 CFAs the benefit sharing arrangement is determined in the constitution. Of the remaining CFAs, carbon developers are involved in determining the benefit sharing arrangement in 13 cases, while FD is involved in three cases and an NGO or traditional leader in one case each.

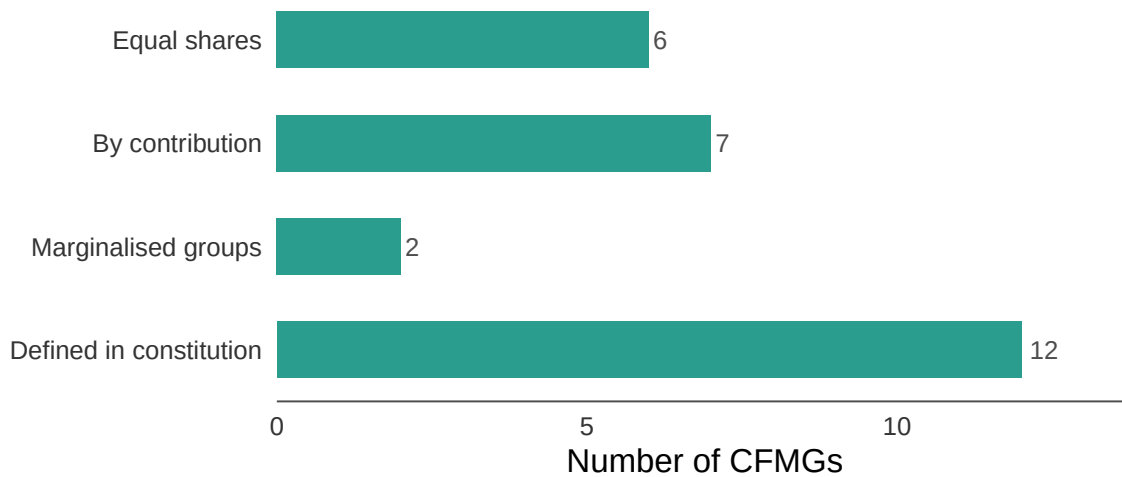


Figure 4: Principles governing carbon income sharing within the community, as reported by CFMG executive FGDs. n = 28 CFMGs responded. Multiple options could be selected.

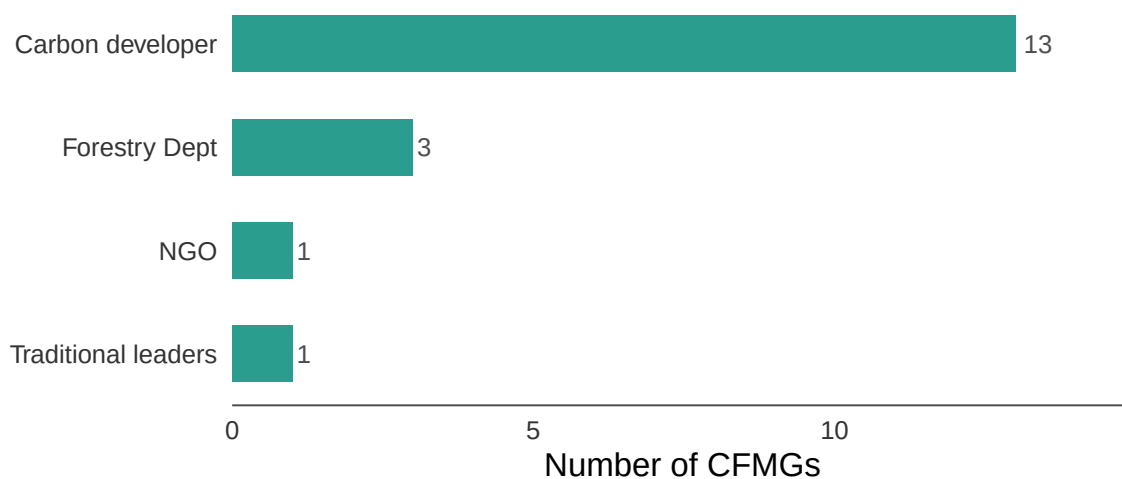


Figure 5: Who from outside the community determines the benefit-sharing arrangement, as reported by CFMG executive FGDs. n = 28 CFMGs responded. Multiple options could be selected. In 12 of the CFMGs, the benefit sharing arrangements are stipulated in the constitution.

Gender equity

We asked FGD groups whether women benefit from CFM (Figure 6). As can be seen in the figure, across all FGD types a majority of groups reported that women benefit from CFM. However, a minority of FGD groups across all types stated that women do not benefit and, moreover, the proportion of FGD groups reporting that women do not benefit was significantly higher for female and youth FGD groups, compared to CFMG Executive and male groups. The governance index was not a significant prediction of this response.

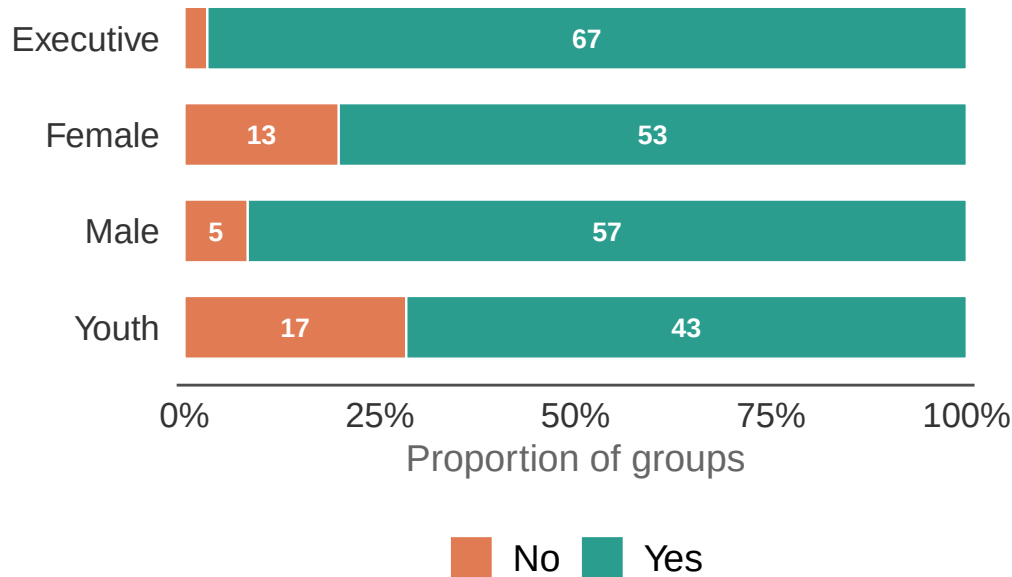


Figure 6: Do women benefit from CFM? The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

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Individual interviewees were also asked whether women benefit from CFM. Table 7 shows the percentage reporting this broken down by interviewee role. Among the individual interviewee respondents a substantial majority agreed that women benefited from CFM. Values varied from 79% of respondents agreeing among traditional leaders to 100% among enterprise representatives. However, these differences among interviewee roles were not significant, and neither was the gender or age of the respondent a significant factor.

Table 5: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on whether communities report that women benefit from CFM.

Model results for women benefit from CFM — FGD type and governance index

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Executive FGD. Province variance = 0; CFA-within-province variance = 1.506. Marginal $R^2 = 0.252$; conditional $R^2 = 0.487$. $n = 240$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Executive FGD)	3.317	1.000	0.0009
Female FGD	-2.453	0.861	0.0044
Male FGD	-0.955	0.924	0.3016
Youth FGD	-2.926	0.864	0.0007
Governance index	0.191	0.136	0.1605

Table 6: Pairwise comparisons among FGD types for whether women benefit from CFM.

Pairwise comparisons — FGD type

Estimates are log-odds differences on the emmeans scale. Tukey-adjusted p-values.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive - Female	2.453	0.861	2.847	0.0229
Executive - Male	0.955	0.924	1.033	0.7301
Executive - Youth	2.926	0.864	3.387	0.0039
Female - Male	-1.498	0.696	-2.151	0.1372
Female - Youth	0.473	0.500	0.946	0.7797
Male - Youth	1.971	0.698	2.825	0.0244

Table 7: Percentage of individual interviewees reporting that women benefit from CFM by interviewee role.

Women benefit from CFM, as reported by individual interviewees

Values represent the % of positive responses. n = the total number of interview responses. A positive response indicates that women benefit from CFM.

Role	n	Agree women benefit from CFM
Community member	31	84%
CFMG executive member	63	95%
Traditional leader	75	79%
District Forestry Officer	56	94%
Private enterprise rep	32	100%

Table 8: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on whether individuals report that women benefit from CFM.

Model results for women benefit from CFM — individual interviewees

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Community member. Province variance = 0; CFA-within-province variance = 7.489. Marginal $R^2 = 0.95$; conditional $R^2 = \text{NA}$. n = 239.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
Intercept (Community member)	1.820	1.947	0.3498
CFMG executive member	0.849	1.241	0.4939
Traditional leader	-1.249	0.972	0.1992
District Forestry Officer	1.661	1.206	0.1682
Private enterprise rep	24.168	70,705.864	0.9997
Male	-0.520	1.062	0.6247
Age	0.048	0.030	0.1090

Women disproportionately suffer opportunity costs

We asked FGD groups whether women disproportionately suffer the opportunity costs of CFM (Figure 7). The results are almost a perfect mirror image of the the results the previous question on whether women benefit from CFM. Across all FGD types most groups said ‘No’, but there was a significantly greater proportion of female and youth FGD groups that felt women did suffer higher opportunity costs.

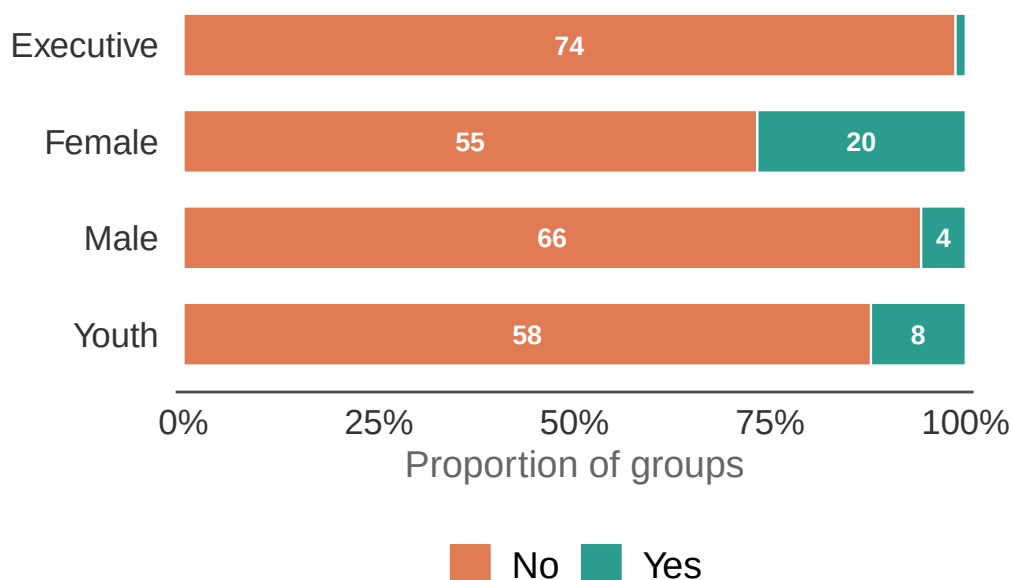


Figure 7: Do women disproportionately suffer the opportunity costs of CFM? The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

Individual interviewees were also asked whether women disproportionately suffer the opportunity costs of CFM. Table 11 shows the percentage reporting this broken down by interviewee role. Again the results were a mirror image of those obtained for whether women benefitted from CFM. Only this time age was a significant factor in determining responses, with older respondents more likely to state that women did experience higher opportunity costs.

Women participate in decision making

We asked FGD groups whether women participate in CFM decision making (Figure 8). The results were very similar to those obtained for the question on whether women benefitted from

Table 9: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on whether communities report that women disproportionately suffer opportunity costs of CFM.

Model results for women disproportionately suffering opportunity costs — FGD type and governance index

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Executive FGD. Province variance = 0.126; CFA-within-province variance = 0. Marginal $R^2 = 0.394$; conditional $R^2 = \text{NA}$. $n = 268$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Executive FGD)	-5.132	1.172	0.0000
Female FGD	3.359	1.065	0.0016
Male FGD	0.202	1.452	0.8893
Youth FGD	2.280	1.105	0.0391
Governance index	0.159	0.105	0.1303

Table 10: Pairwise comparisons among FGD types for whether women disproportionately suffer opportunity costs of CFM.

Pairwise comparisons — FGD type

Estimates are log-odds differences on the emmeans scale. Tukey-adjusted p-values.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive - Female	-3.359	1.065	-3.154	0.0087
Executive - Male	-0.202	1.452	-0.139	0.9990
Executive - Youth	-2.280	1.105	-2.063	0.1654
Female - Male	3.157	1.066	2.961	0.0162
Female - Youth	1.079	0.496	2.175	0.1301
Male - Youth	-2.078	1.107	-1.878	0.2376

Table 11: Percentage of individual interviewees reporting that women disproportionately suffer the opportunity costs of CFM by interviewee role.

Women disproportionately suffer opportunity costs, as reported by individual interviewees

Values represent the % of positive responses. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Agree women disproportionately suffer opportunity costs
Community member	31	29%
CFMG executive member	63	18%
Traditional leader	75	18%
District Forestry Officer	56	21%
Private enterprise rep	32	7%

Table 12: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on whether individuals report that women disproportionately suffer opportunity costs of CFM.

Model results for women disproportionately suffering opportunity costs — individual interviewees

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Community member. Province variance = 0.293; CFA-within-province variance = 0. Marginal $R^2 = 0.09$; conditional $R^2 = 0.165$. n = 239.

Factor	Estimate	SE	P value
Intercept (Community member)	-2.045	0.976	0.0363
CFMG executive member	-0.792	0.586	0.1765
Traditional leader	-0.946	0.584	0.1054
District Forestry Officer	-0.217	0.609	0.7217
Private enterprise rep	-1.458	0.884	0.0993
Male	-0.549	0.431	0.2025
Age	0.031	0.015	0.0401

CFM. A substantial majority of groups stated that women did participate in decision making, but a significantly greater proportion of female and youth FGD groups said they did not.

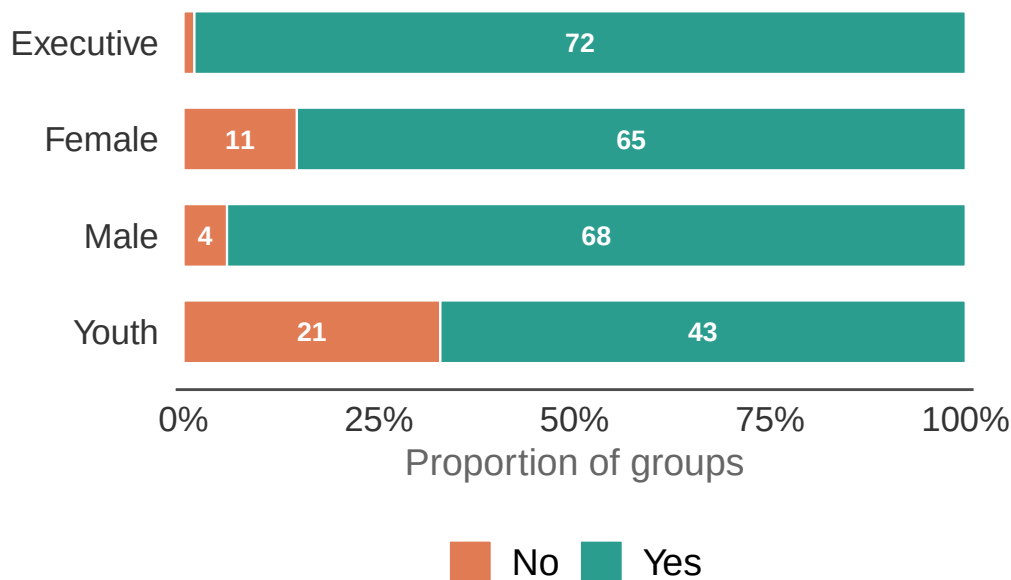


Figure 8: Do women participate in CFM decision making? The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

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Individual interviewees were also asked whether women participate in CFM decision making. Table 15 shows the percentage reporting this broken down by interviewee role. Very high proportions of individual interviewees responded that women did participate in decision making, varying from 92% among traditional leaders and DFOs to 100% among community members. There were no significant differences among interviewee roles in their responses to this question.

Transparency in benefit sharing

We asked FGD groups whether there is transparency in CFM benefit sharing (Figure 9). Interestingly, the answers to this question were more varied than to the previous questions. However, across all FGD types a majority of groups agreed that there was transparency in the benefit sharing. However, all the community FGD types were significantly more likely to disagree as compared to the CFMG Executive FGDs. In addition, governance index score was

Table 13: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on whether communities report that women participate in CFM decision making.

Model results for women participation in CFM decision making — FGD type and governance index

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Executive FGD. Province variance = 0.491; CFA-within-province variance = 1.446. Marginal $R^2 = 0.356$; conditional $R^2 = 0.595$. $n = 267$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Executive FGD)	4.576	1.351	0.0007
Female FGD	-2.575	1.109	0.0202
Male FGD	-0.077	1.448	0.9575
Youth FGD	-3.957	1.146	0.0006
Governance index	0.118	0.148	0.4228

Table 14: Pairwise comparisons among FGD types for whether women participate in CFM decision making.

Pairwise comparisons — FGD type

Estimates are log-odds differences on the emmeans scale. Tukey-adjusted p-values.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive - Female	2.575	1.109	2.322	0.0930
Executive - Male	0.077	1.448	0.053	0.9999
Executive - Youth	3.957	1.146	3.453	0.0031
Female - Male	-2.498	1.114	-2.243	0.1118
Female - Youth	1.382	0.569	2.430	0.0716
Male - Youth	3.880	1.154	3.363	0.0043

Table 15: Percentage of individual interviewees reporting that women participate in CFM decision making by interviewee role.

Women participate in CFM decision making, as reported by individual interviewees

Values represent the % of positive responses. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Agree women participate in decision making
Community member	31	100%
CFMG executive member	63	95%
Traditional leader	75	92%
District Forestry Officer	56	92%
Private enterprise rep	32	97%

Table 16: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on whether individuals report that women participate in CFM decision making.

Model results for women participation in CFM decision making — individual interviewees

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Community member. Province variance = 0.891; CFA-within-province variance = 0.359. Marginal $R^2 = 0.902$; conditional $R^2 = 0.929$. n = 252.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Community member)	21.616	351.236	0.9509
CFMG executive member	-19.157	351.230	0.9565
Traditional leader	-20.226	351.230	0.9541
District Forestry Officer	-19.524	351.230	0.9557
Private enterprise rep	-18.832	351.231	0.9572
Male	0.246	0.738	0.7386
Age	0.019	0.031	0.5468

a highly significant predictor of the probability that a FGD group would agree that benefit sharing was transparent.

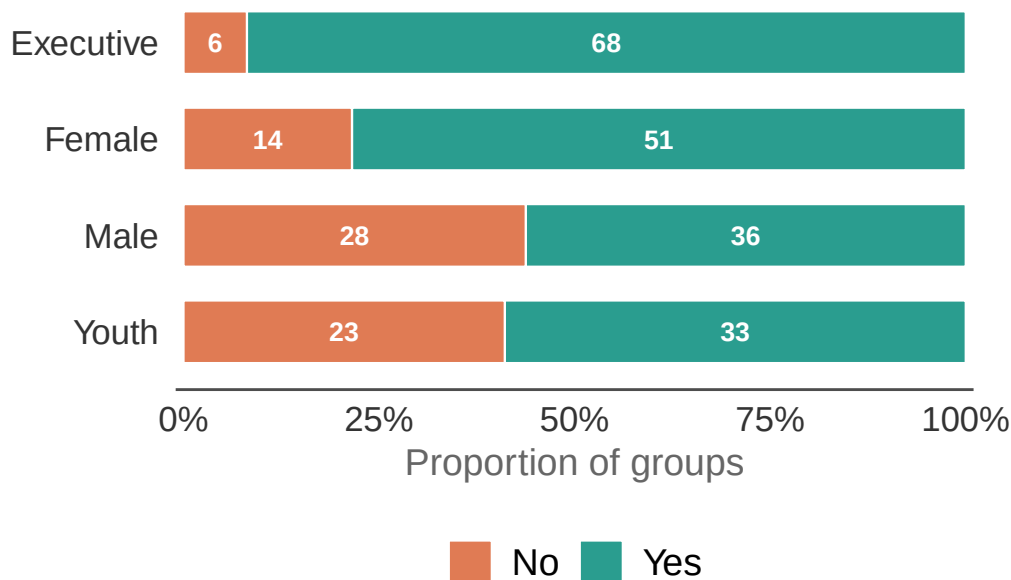


Figure 9: Is there transparency in CFM benefit sharing? The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

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Individual interviewees were also asked whether there is transparency in CFM benefit sharing. Table 19 shows the percentage reporting this broken down by interviewee role. A substantial majority of individual interviewees agreed that benefit sharing was transparent, varying from 76% among traditional leaders to 93% among CFMG Executive members. The differences among interviewee roles were not significant.

We examined which mechanisms are being used to achieve transparency in benefit sharing among the community female, male, and youth FGDs (Figure 10). As can be seen from the figure, community meetings were recognised as by far the most important mechanism for achieving transparency. It is noteworthy that written agreements and financial reports were relatively infrequently mentioned. Although community meetings may be the most important to communicate, the formal CFMG processes such as annual financial reporting are also critical underpinnings of transparency. As our results from the governance chapter also showed, reporting by CFMGs does not appear to be adequate.

Table 17: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on whether communities report transparency in CFM benefit sharing.

Model results for transparency in CFM benefit sharing — FGD type and governance index

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Executive FGD. Province variance = 0.142; CFA-within-province variance = 0.306. Marginal $R^2 = 0.278$; conditional $R^2 = 0.365$. $n = 242$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Executive FGD)	1.184	0.597	0.0472
Female FGD	-1.153	0.567	0.0420
Male FGD	-2.306	0.564	0.0000
Youth FGD	-2.023	0.559	0.0003
Governance index	0.340	0.104	0.0011

Table 18: Pairwise comparisons among FGD types for transparency in CFM benefit sharing.

Pairwise comparisons — FGD type

Estimates are log-odds differences on the emmeans scale. Tukey-adjusted p-values.

Contrast	Estimate	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive - Female	1.153	0.567	2.033	0.1757
Executive - Male	2.306	0.564	4.085	0.0003
Executive - Youth	2.023	0.559	3.616	0.0017
Female - Male	1.153	0.472	2.440	0.0697
Female - Youth	0.869	0.472	1.841	0.2539
Male - Youth	-0.283	0.437	-0.648	0.9161

Table 19: Percentage of individual interviewees reporting that there is transparency in CFM benefit sharing by interviewee role.

Transparency in CFM benefit sharing, as reported by individual interviewees

Values represent the % of positive responses. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Agree there is transparency in benefit sharing
Community member	31	92%
CFMG executive member	63	93%
Traditional leader	75	76%
District Forestry Officer	56	79%
Private enterprise rep	32	80%

Table 20: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on whether individuals report transparency in CFM benefit sharing.

Model results for transparency in CFM benefit sharing — individual interviewees

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Community member. Province variance = 0.44; CFA-within-province variance = 0.465. Marginal $R^2 = 0.123$; conditional $R^2 = 0.312$. n = 237.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Community member)	3.305	1.416	0.0196
CFMG executive member	0.070	0.981	0.9431
Traditional leader	-1.529	0.869	0.0784
District Forestry Officer	-1.390	0.941	0.1397
Private enterprise rep	-1.506	0.989	0.1280
Male	0.445	0.524	0.3961
Age	-0.016	0.019	0.3924

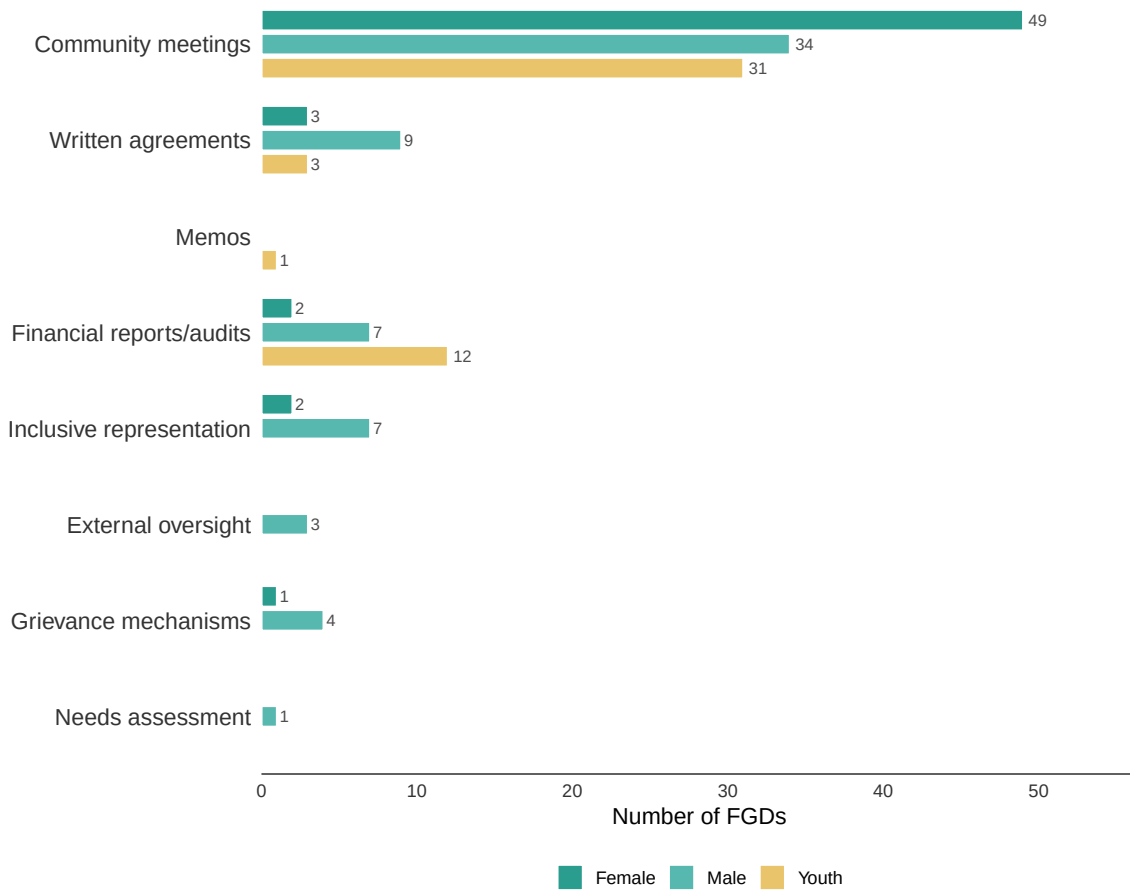


Figure 10: Mechanisms used to achieve transparency in CFM benefit sharing, as reported by community female, male, and youth FGDs. Bars show the number of FGDs reporting each mechanism.

Grievance and Redress

We asked FGD groups whether their CFMG has a grievance and redress mechanism in place (Figure 11). As can be seen in the figure, a substantial majority of FGD groups reported that they had a grievance and redress mechanism. However, a small number of Executive FGDs reported they did not have any mechanism, which is concerning. Moreover, a larger number of community FGD groups said there was no grievance and redress mechanism, which suggests that information about the availability of the process is not always being adequately communicated. The differences in responses between Executive FGDs and all three community groups were significant.

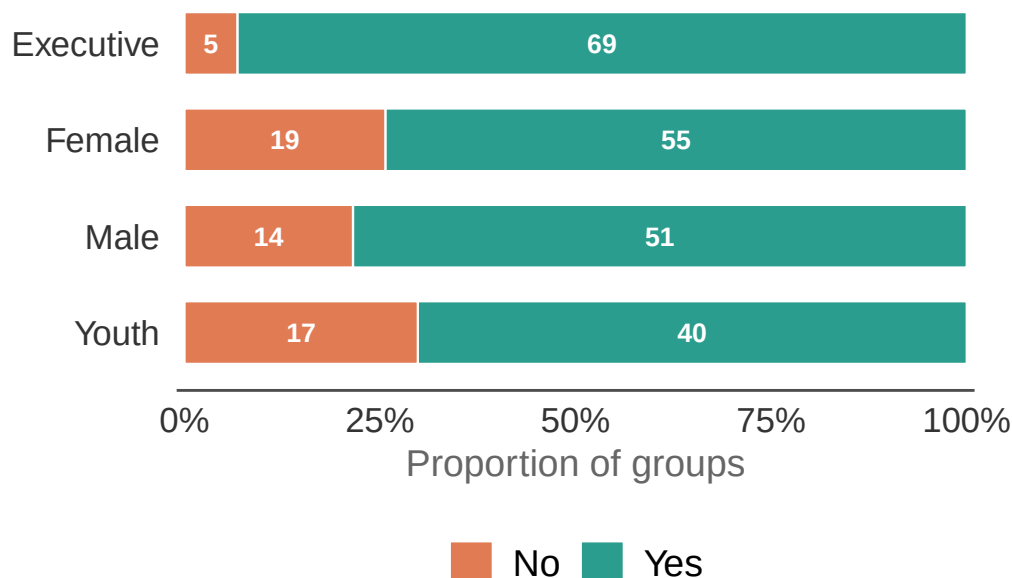


Figure 11: Does the CFMG have a grievance and redress mechanism? The length of each bar segment represents the proportion of groups in that category. The numbers superimposed on the bars represent the actual number of groups in each category.

Individual interviewees were also asked whether their CFMG has a grievance and redress mechanism. Table 23 shows the percentage reporting this broken down by interviewee role and as can be seen most stated that there was a mechanism in place. However, minority of around 10-20% stated that the CFMG lacked any such process. The differences among interviewee roles were not significant.

We also examined which mechanisms are being used to achieve grievance and redress among the community female, male, and youth FGDs (Figure 12). As can be seen, the main mechanism

Table 21: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type on whether communities report having a grievance and redress mechanism.

Model results for grievance and redress mechanism — FGD type

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Executive FGD. Province variance = 0.168; CFA-within-province variance = 0.056. Marginal $R^2 = 0.125$; conditional $R^2 = 0.181$. $n = 270$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Executive FGD)	2.642	0.513	0.0000
Female FGD	-1.570	0.540	0.0036
Male FGD	-1.303	0.560	0.0199
Youth FGD	-1.791	0.555	0.0013

Table 22: Pairwise comparisons among FGD types for grievance and redress mechanism.

Pairwise comparisons — FGD type

Estimates are odds ratios on the response scale. Tukey-adjusted p-values.

Contrast	Odds ratio	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
Executive / Female	4.807	2.595	2.909	0.0190
Executive / Male	3.680	2.060	2.328	0.0918
Executive / Youth	5.995	3.328	3.226	0.0069
Female / Male	0.765	0.314	-0.652	0.9148
Female / Youth	1.247	0.502	0.549	0.9470
Male / Youth	1.629	0.699	1.137	0.6666

Table 23: Percentage of individual interviewees reporting that the CFMG has a grievance and redress mechanism by interviewee role.

Grievance and redress mechanism, as reported by individual interviewees

Values represent the % of positive responses. n = the total number of interview responses.

Role	n	Grievance and redress mechanism
Community member	31	97%
CFMG executive member	63	90%
Traditional leader	75	86%
District Forestry Officer	56	77%
Private enterprise rep	32	86%

Table 24: Results of the model examining the effect of interviewee role, gender and age on whether individuals report having a grievance and redress mechanism.

Model results for grievance and redress mechanism — individual interviewees

Estimates are log-odds; reference = Community member. Province variance = 0.255; CFA-within-province variance = 0. Marginal $R^2 = 0.111$; conditional $R^2 = 0.175$. n = 240.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept (Community member)	3.250	1.549	0.0359
CFMG executive member	-1.205	1.128	0.2853
Traditional leader	-1.579	1.089	0.1472
District Forestry Officer	-2.155	1.122	0.0548
Private enterprise rep	-1.588	1.201	0.1861
Male	0.791	0.479	0.0987
Age	-0.009	0.020	0.6400

Table 25: Pairwise comparisons among interviewee roles for grievance and redress mechanism.

Pairwise comparisons — interviewee role

Estimates are odds ratios on the response scale. Tukey-adjusted p-values.

Contrast	Odds ratio	SE	z ratio	<i>P</i> value
cfmg_member / cfmg_exec_member	3.337	3.764	1.068	0.8228
cfmg_member / trad_leader	4.850	5.283	1.450	0.5955
cfmg_member / dfo	8.631	9.685	1.921	0.3061
cfmg_member / NGO_rep	4.894	5.879	1.322	0.6774
cfmg_exec_member / trad_leader	1.453	0.899	0.604	0.9745
cfmg_exec_member / dfo	2.586	1.551	1.585	0.5073
cfmg_exec_member / NGO_rep	1.467	1.078	0.521	0.9853
trad_leader / dfo	1.780	1.065	0.963	0.8717
trad_leader / NGO_rep	1.009	0.747	0.012	1.0000
dfo / NGO_rep	0.567	0.377	-0.853	0.9138

include community meetings, mediation by traditional leaders and formal grievance and redress committees. The focus on local solutions is a positive finding.

Impact on poverty

We asked the community female, male, and youth FGDs to identify the ways in which CFM has had an impact on poverty in their communities (Figure 13). Increase in household incomes was the most commonly stated impact on poverty followed by increased nutrition and food security. However, it is interesting to note the number of different types of responses that were given.

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Barriers to poorer community members

We asked the community female, male, and youth FGDs to identify the barriers that prevent poorer community members from benefiting from CFM (Figure 14). Most often mentioned was “Limited information”. However, more concerning were responses like, “Excluded from decisions”, “Unequal benefit distribution” and “No trust in leadership”.

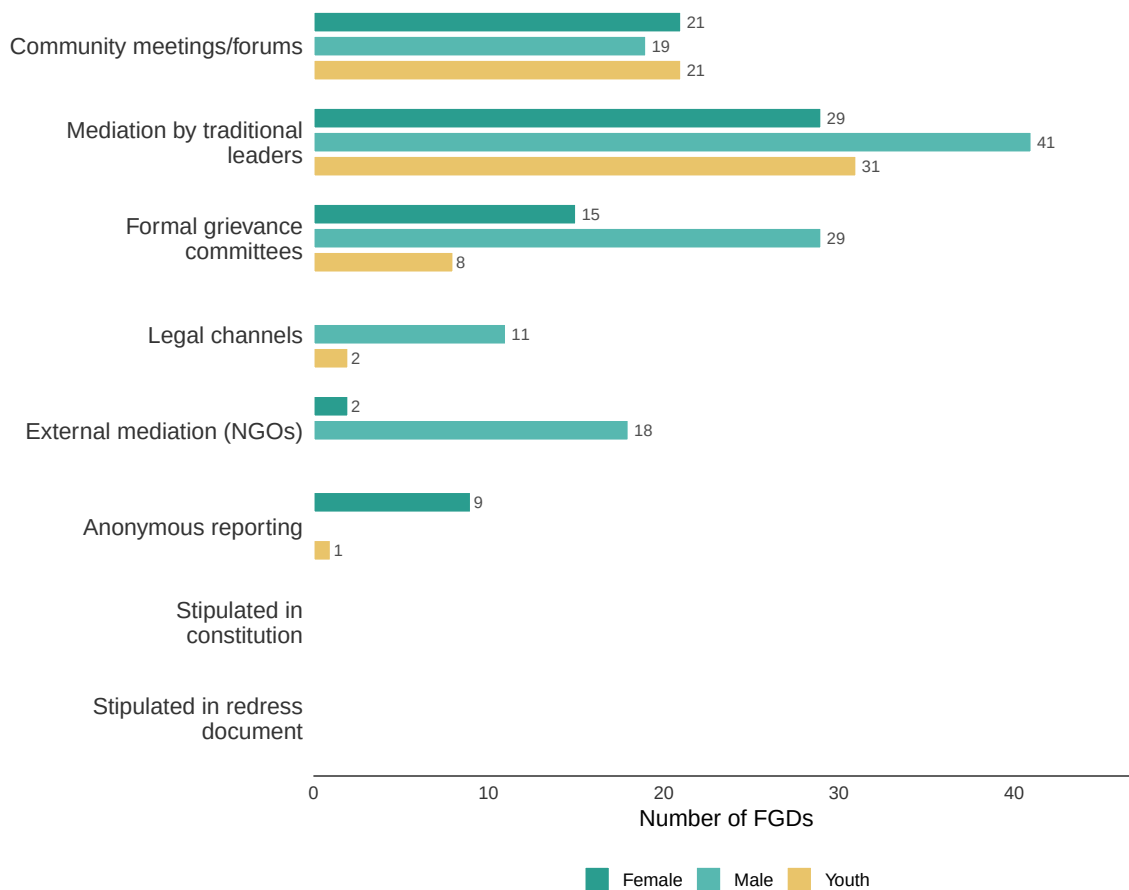


Figure 12: Mechanisms used for grievance and redress in CFMGs, as reported by community female, male, and youth FGDs. Bars show the number of FGDs reporting each mechanism.

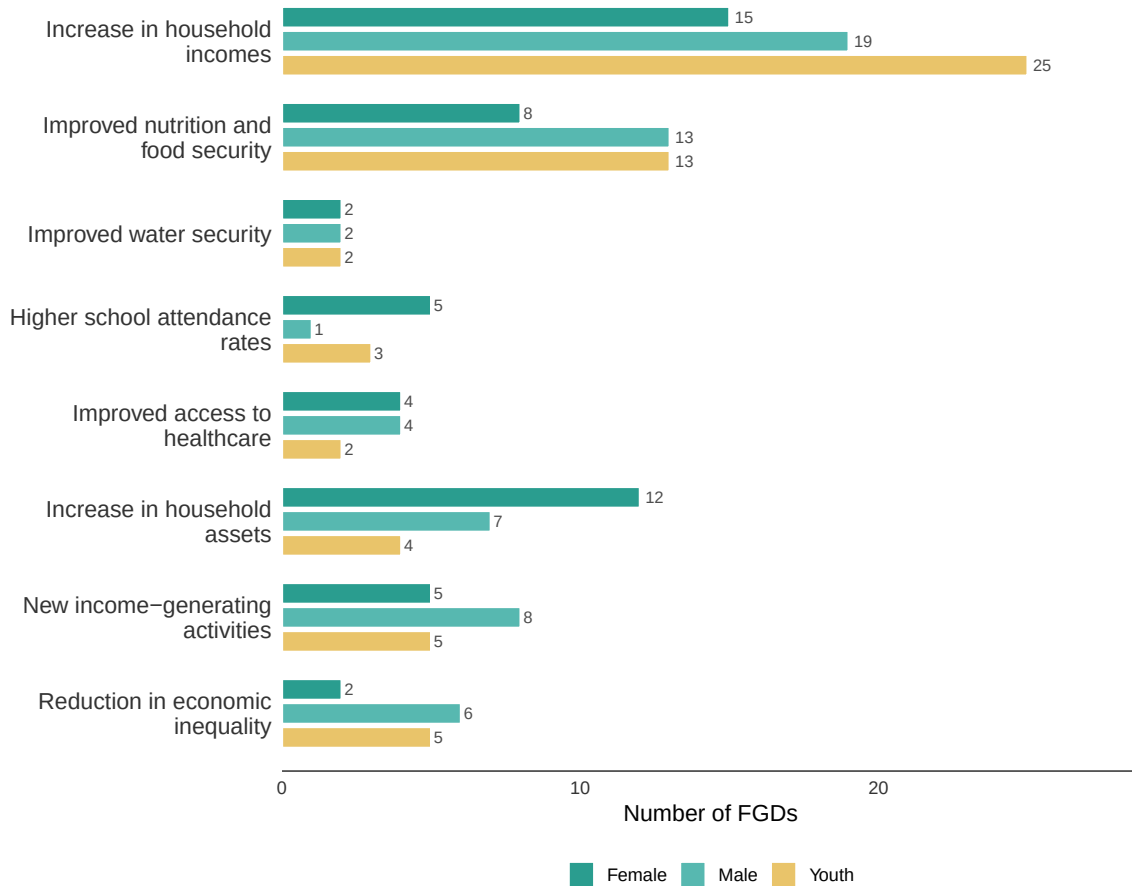


Figure 13: Reported impacts of CFM on poverty, as identified by community female, male, and youth FGDs. Bars show the number of FGDs reporting each impact.



Figure 14: Barriers preventing poorer community members from benefiting from CFM, as reported by community female, male, and youth FGDs. Word size is proportional to the number of FGDs reporting each barrier.

Addressing challenges

We asked the community female, male, and youth FGDs to suggest solutions to address the barriers facing poorer community members in benefiting from CFM (Figure 15). Far and away the most popular solution for addressing these barriers was community meetings.

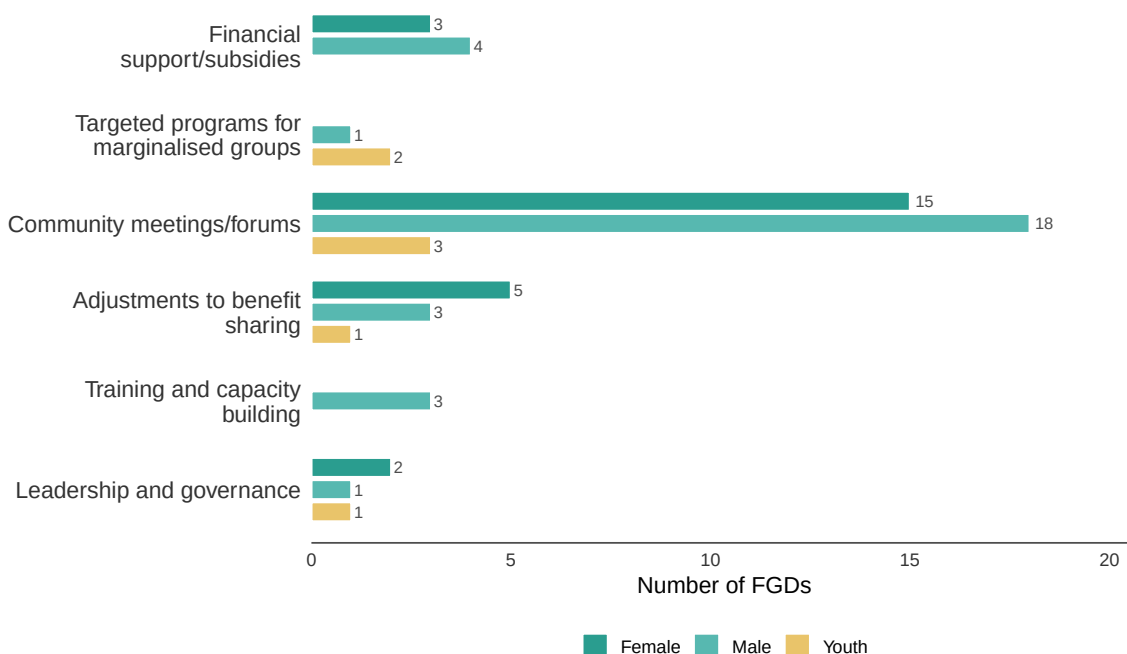


Figure 15: Suggested solutions to address barriers preventing poorer community members from benefiting from CFM, as reported by community female, male, and youth FGDs. Bars show the number of FGDs reporting each solution.

Equity and inclusion index

To summarise the overall equity and inclusion performance of each CFMG, we constructed an equity and inclusion score (0–5) by summing five binary indicators reported by FGD groups — equitable benefit sharing, women benefiting from CFM, women participating in decision making, transparency in benefit sharing, and existence of a grievance and redress mechanism — each scored as 1 (positive outcome reported) or 0 (no positive outcome). The distribution of equity and inclusion scores across CFMGs is shown in Figure 16 (Appendix III). We then modelled this score using a linear mixed model with FGD type and the governance index as predictors, and random intercepts for province and CFA within province, to test whether governance and FGD type were significant predictors of overall equity and inclusion performance

(Table 26, Figure 17).

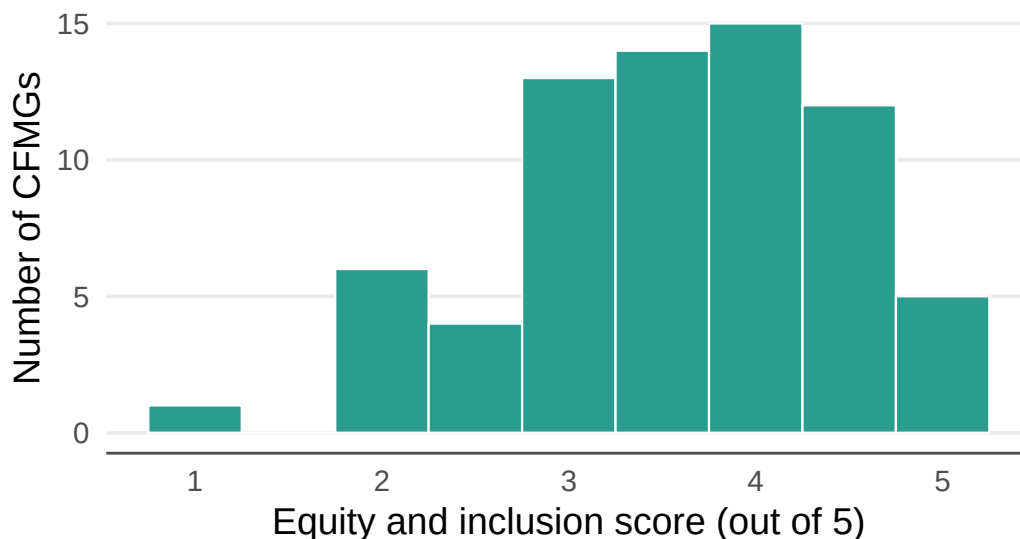


Figure 16: Distribution of mean equity and inclusion scores across CFMGs (0–5). Each bar represents the number of CFMGs with that mean score, averaged across all FGD types. The score sums five binary indicators: equitable benefit sharing, women benefiting from CFM, women participating in decision making, transparency in benefit sharing, and existence of a grievance and redress mechanism.

As can be seen from the model results, all three community FGD groups had significantly lower equity and inclusion scores compared to the CFMG Executive FGDs. Thus, the community groups all scored their CFM lower on equity and inclusion compared to the CFMG Executives. This indicates a pervasive difference in perception between communities and the CFMG Executives concerning the fairness of the CFM processes. The governance index was also a highly significant predictor of the equity and inclusion score, indicating that better governed CFMGs had better equity and inclusion scores.

Discussion

Through the FGDs and individual interviews, we investigated a wide range of equity and inclusion indicators, covering benefit sharing, gender equity, transparency, grievance and redress, and poverty impacts.

The most striking and consistent finding is a divergence in perspective by FGD group. Across virtually every indicator — equitable benefit sharing, women benefiting from CFM, women suffering disproportionate opportunity costs, women’s participation in decision making, and transparency in benefit sharing — community female and youth groups were significantly more

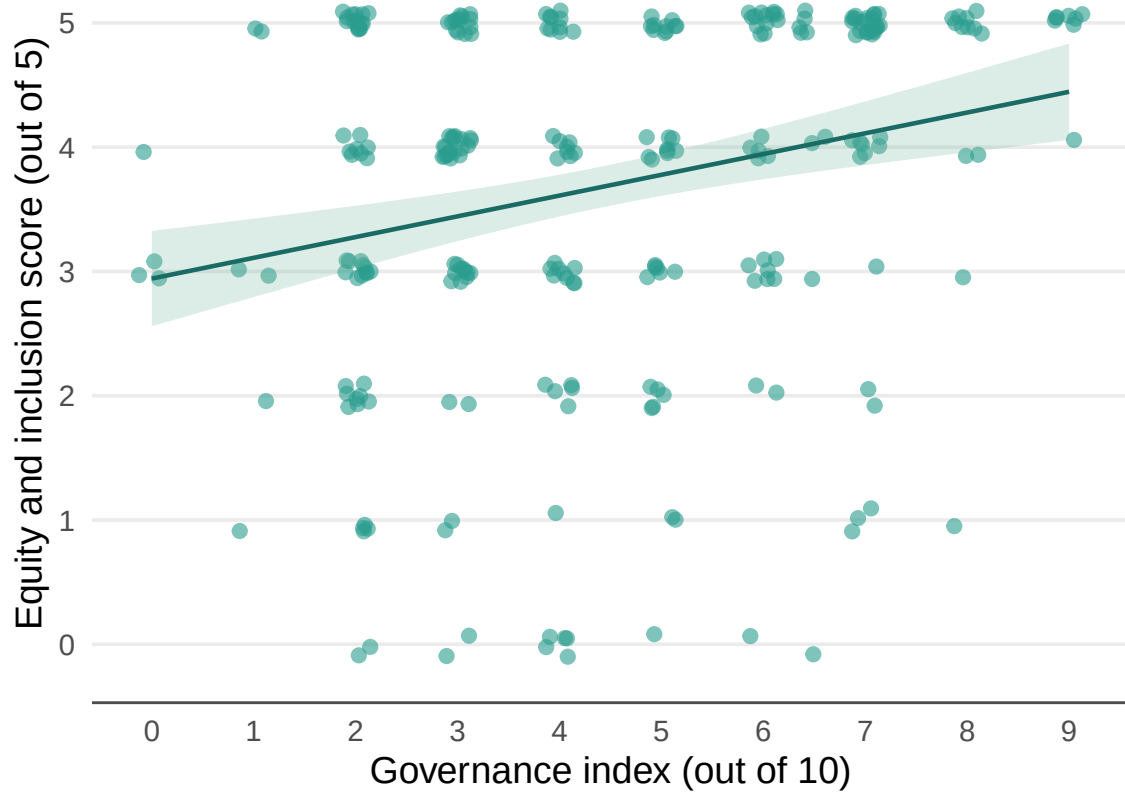


Figure 17: Relationship between the CFMG governance index and equity and inclusion score. Each point represents one FGD session. The line shows the fitted relationship from the linear mixed model, with the shaded band representing ± 1 SE.

Table 26: Results of the model examining the effect of FGD type and governance index on equity and inclusion performance.

Model results for equity and inclusion performance — FGD type and governance index

Linear mixed model with random intercepts for province and CFA within province. Reference = Executive. Province variance = 0.095; CFA-within-province variance = 0.233; residual variance = 1.355. Marginal $R^2 = 0.19$; conditional $R^2 = 0.348$. $n = 273$.

Factor	Estimate	SE	<i>P</i> value
Intercept	3.589	0.277	0.0000
Female	-0.873	0.195	0.0000
Male	-0.664	0.199	0.0010
Youth	-1.373	0.197	0.0000
Governance index	0.171	0.046	0.0004

likely than CFMG executive and male groups to report negative outcomes. Given that CFMG executives and community males may typically be better informed about formal governance arrangements, it is possible that this divergence reflects an information asymmetry rather than disagreement about conditions. However, it may also reflect that the benefits and costs of CFM are being distributed unevenly, in ways that are visible to female and youth community members but not acknowledged — or perhaps not noticed — by those in the CFMG executives. It is also possible that these differences in perspective reflect elite capture or corruption.

Notwithstanding these these issues, the overall picture is more positive than might have been expected. A clear majority of all FGD groups — including community female groups — reported that benefits are being shared equitably and that women benefit from CFM. Most female groups also stated that women do not disproportionately suffer opportunity costs and that women participate in CFM decision making. This is somewhat surprising, given that natural resource management decisions in Zambia are traditionally the purview of male community members. It may be that the formal governance structures mandated by CFM — elections, executive positions with female representation, and documented benefit-sharing arrangements — are providing women with a degree of recognition and voice that they would not otherwise have had. These results may also explain why women FGDs also had a more positive take on the effect of CFM on SFM, as mentioned in that chapter.

Carbon benefit-sharing agreements between companies and communities are almost entirely structured around revenue sharing. Employment, infrastructure investment and livelihood support are less commonly included in these agreements. While revenue sharing provides a direct financial return, it means communities that have not yet received a carbon payment have little to show for CFM. Diversifying the components of company-community agreements could

broaden both the distribution of benefits and community buy-in. The fact that only the CFMG Executives determine the sharing of carbon revenue in a number of CFMGs is concerning. This is a lot of authority for the CFMG Executive to assume, and even if the benefit sharing is done appropriately it is likely to attract accusations of nepotism or corruption. We suggest that there should be greater standardisation of benefit-sharing arrangements, both between the carbon developer and the community and within the community. It is also essential that the FD provide greater oversight to ensure agreed upon benefit-sharing arrangements are being properly implemented.

The reported poverty impacts of CFM — primarily increased household incomes and new income-generating activities — are broadly consistent with the economic transformation chapter findings. However, barriers to poorer community members benefiting remain, including limited access to resources, capital and markets. The solutions communities themselves proposed — financial support, targeted programmes for marginalised groups, and better governance — align closely with the governance and economic transformation recommendations identified elsewhere in this report.

In conclusion, the equity and inclusion outcomes of CFM in Zambia are broadly positive but uneven. The divergence between female and youth perspectives and those of CFMG executives is the most important finding of this chapter. It signals that equity problems exist in a subset of CFMGs, and that strengthening transparency, grievance and redress mechanisms and community-wide engagement is essential to ensuring CFM benefits reach all community members equitably.